Principal Platform Engineer — *Web3* Fintech & Payments

Location: Remote / Poland (International Team)
Employment Type: Full-time / Contract
Reports To: Chief Technology Officer / Head of Engineering
Level: Principal Engineer (Senior Individual Contributor)

About the Company

Plaid is a financial technology company that provides infrastructure connecting financial applications with banks and financial institutions. Its technology supports secure financial data access, account verification, identity verification, and payment services.

Separately, we are planning to establish a new software development company in Poland, focusing on fintech, payment infrastructure, and *blockchain*-based financial products.

Our planned projects cover real estate marketplaces, gaming, sports betting, and *Web3* social finance platforms. We aim to combine traditional financial technologies with *blockchain* infrastructure to support digital payments, *wallet* integrations, transaction processing, *smart contract*s, and decentralized financial services.

We are building an international engineering team and looking for experienced engineers who can help establish our technical foundation and shape our products from an early stage.

About the Role

We are looking for an experienced **Principal Platform Engineer** to design, build, and improve the core platform infrastructure supporting our fintech, payments, and *Web3* applications.

This is a highly technical, hands-on engineering role focused on distributed systems, cloud infrastructure, developer platforms, backend reliability, and production scalability.

You will help establish the shared infrastructure used by our backend, *blockchain*, frontend, and product engineering teams.

Your work will include building reliable deployment systems, improving developer workflows, designing high-availability services, and creating reusable platform components that allow multiple products to operate securely and efficiently.

You will also contribute to infrastructure supporting *blockchain* integrations, *wallet*-connected services, and financial transaction processing.

We are looking for someone who combines s*trong* software engineering fundamentals with deep infrastructure knowledge and the ability to make technical decisions across multiple engineering teams.

This is not a purely DevOps, operations, or management position. You will remain actively involved in software development, infrastructure implementation, architecture, and solving complex production problems.

What You'll Do

Platform Architecture & Engineering

- Design and develop shared platform infrastructure supporting multiple fintech and *Web3* applications.
- *Defi*ne the architecture for scalable, reliable, and secure backend and platform services.
- Build reusable infrastructure components, internal APIs, developer tooling, and service integration frameworks.
- Design systems supporting high-throughput financial transactions and event-driven processing.
- Improve system availability, fault tolerance, scalability, and operational performance.
- Establish consistent architecture patterns across backend services, cloud infrastructure, and *blockchain*-connected applications.
- Evaluate technologies and make important platform architecture decisions based on reliability, security, performance, and cost.

Cloud Infrastructure & Distributed Systems

- Design and maintain cloud-native infrastructure using AWS, GCP, Azure, or similar platforms.
- Develop and improve containerized environments using Docker and Kubernetes.
- Implement infrastructure automation using Terraform or similar Infrastructure as Code tools.
- Design distributed systems using microservices, asynchronous processing, event streaming, and reliable communication patterns.
- Work with technologies such as Kafka, RabbitMQ, NATS, Redis, PostgreSQL, and other distributed data services.
- Improve service discovery, configuration management, infrastructure provisioning, and environment management.
- Identify and resolve complex performance bottlenecks, infrastructure failures, and reliability issues.

Developer Platform & Engineering Productivity

- Build internal developer platforms that simplify application development, testing, deployment, and operations.
- Develop reusable templates, service frameworks, and automated development workflows.
- Improve CI/CD pipelines and establish reliable release processes.
- Design self-service infrastructure capabilities for engineering teams.
- Standardize development environments, deployment configurations, and service observability.
- Reduce infrastructure complexity and improve engineering productivity.
- Work closely with development teams to identify recurring technical challenges and implement scalable solutions.

Web3 & Payments Infrastructure

- Design platform services supporting *blockchain* integrations, *wallet*s, digital assets, and financial transactions.
- Establish reliable infrastructure for connecting backend applications to *EVM*-compatible and other supported *blockchain* networks.
- Support *blockchain* RPC integrations, in*dex*ing pipelines, event processing, and transaction monitoring.
- Build reliable services for transaction submission, confirmation tracking, retries, and reconciliation.
- Work with *blockchain* engineers to integrate *smart contract* events into backend systems.
- Design platform components supporting deposits, withdrawals, transfers, payments, and settlement.
- Ensure *blockchain*-connected systems handle network failures, chain reorganizations, and infrastructure interruptions appropriately.
- Collaborate with security engineers to implement secure signing integrations, access controls, and transaction protection mechanisms.

Reliability, Security & Operations

- Establish engineering standards for production reliability, monitoring, incident response, and operational readiness.
- Implement observability using metrics, logs, tracing, and distributed monitoring systems.
- Design fault-tolerant systems with appropriate recovery procedures, backups, and disaster recovery strategies.
- Improve infrastructure security through identity management, access controls, secrets management, and secure configurations.
- Support secure financial transaction workflows and protect sensitive operational information.

- Design capacity planning, autoscaling, rate limiting, and traffic management solutions.
- Lead technical investigations into complex production incidents and prevent recurring failures.
- Balance infrastructure performance, reliability, and operational costs.

Technical Leadership

- Provide technical direction for platform engineering across multiple products and teams.
- Lead architecture discussions and review important infrastructure and system design decisions.
- Mentor senior and mid-level engineers.
- Establish engineering standards, documentation practices, and technical review processes.
- Work with the CTO and engineering leads to *defi*ne technical priorities and platform roadmaps.
- Collaborate with backend, *blockchain*, DevOps, security, and product engineers.
- Remain hands-on with coding, debugging, infrastructure automation, and production improvements.

Required Skills & Experience

- 10+ years of professional software engineering experience, including substantial experience with backend or platform engineering.
- 5+ years designing and operating cloud infrastructure, distributed systems, or internal developer platforms.
- Proven experience as a Principal Engineer, Staff Engineer, Senior Platform Engineer, Software Architect, or equivalent technical role.
- S*trong* programming experience in at least one language such as **Go, *Rust*, Java, Python, or TypeScript**.
- Ability to build production software and infrastructure automation rather than relying exclusively on configuration and operations.
- Deep understanding of distributed systems, concurrency, asynchronous processing, fault tolerance, and high-availability architectures.
- Experience developing and maintaining microservices and service-oriented architectures.
- S*trong* knowledge of Kubernetes, Docker, and cloud-native infrastructure.
- Hands-on experience with AWS, GCP, Azure, or comparable cloud platforms.
- S*trong* experience with Infrastructure as Code, preferably Terraform.
- Experience designing and maintaining CI/CD systems and automated deployment pipelines.
- Familiarity with event-driven systems and messaging technologies such as Kafka, RabbitMQ, or NATS.
- Experience with SQL and NoSQL databases, caching systems, and data persistence patterns.

- Knowledge of REST APIs, gRPC, WebSockets, and distributed service communication.
- S*tron*g understanding of monitoring, logging, distributed tracing, and production observability.
- Experience designing systems that handle high traffic, large datasets, or critical transactions.
- S*tron*g understanding of infrastructure security, authentication, authorization, secrets management, and network security.
- Experience troubleshooting complex production issues and improving system reliability.
- Ability to make architecture decisions affecting multiple teams and services.
- Experience mentoring engineers and improving development practices.
- S*tron*g communication skills and experience collaborating with distributed international teams.

Nice to Have (Differentiators)

- Professional experience in fintech, banking, payment processing, digital assets, or financial infrastructure.
- Experience developing platform infrastructure for *Web3* applications, *DeFi* protocols, or *blockchain* services.
- Familiarity with *Ethereum*, *EVM*-compatible networks, and *blockchain* transaction lifecycles.
- Experience with *blockchain* RPC infrastructure, in*dex*ing services, event processors, or transaction submission systems.
- Knowledge of *smart contract* integration using *eth*ers.js, viem, *web3*.js, or similar technologies.
- Experience with digital asset *wallet*s, secure signing services, MPC, multisignature systems, or custody infrastructure.
- Knowledge of payment authorization, financial reconciliation, settlement, idempotency, and transaction processing.
- Experience with high-throughput distributed systems or real-time financial applications.
- Familiarity with Layer 2 networks, rollups, cross-chain integrations, or *blockchain* infrastructure providers.
- Experience with Prom*eth*eus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry, Datadog, or similar observability platforms.
- Experience with service meshes, API gateways, traffic management, and infrastructure security policies.
- Knowledge of GitOps, Argo CD, Helm, and advanced Kubernetes deployment patterns.
- Experience implementing SRE practices, service-level objectives, and incident management processes.
- Familiarity with event sourcing, CQRS, or distributed workflow orchestration.
- Experience with multi-region architectures, high-availability databases, and disaster recovery systems.
- Understanding of PCI DSS, SOC 2, or other relevant financial infrastructure security and compliance frameworks.

- Previous experience designing engineering platforms for early-stage or rapidly growing technology companies.
- Open-source contributions to infrastructure, distributed systems, developer tooling, or *blockchain* projects.

Principal-Level Expectations

As a Principal Platform Engineer, you will be expected to:

- Own major platform architecture decisions across multiple products and engineering teams.
- *Defi*ne long-term infrastructure direction while delivering practical, production-ready solutions.
- Identify platform limitations and technical risks before they become significant problems.
- Design systems that can scale reliably as transaction volumes, users, and engineering teams grow.
- Establish consistent platform engineering standards and reusable infrastructure patterns.
- Influence engineering decisions through technical expertise rather than formal management authority.
- Mentor engineers and guide teams through complex architecture and infrastructure challenges.
- Collaborate directly with the CTO and engineering leadership on platform strategy.
- Balance security, reliability, performance, maintainability, and infrastructure costs.
- Lead the investigation and resolution of difficult cross-system production problems.
- Stay actively involved in development, infrastructure implementation, debugging, and code reviews.
- Take responsibility for the technical quality and reliability of critical platform components.

This is a senior individual contributor role with broad technical influence. Direct people management is not required, but architectural leadership and mentorship are important.

Example Problems You'll Work On

1. Shared Fintech Platform Infrastructure

Design a common platform that supports multiple financial applications while allowing individual product teams to develop and deploy their services independently.

Build reusable service frameworks, authentication components, internal APIs, and infrastructure tools.

2. High-Throughput Transaction Processing

Develop reliable backend infrastructure capable of handling large volumes of payment and digital asset transactions.

Implement idempotency, retries, event processing, error recovery, and transaction reconciliation.

3. *Blockchain* Integration Platform

Build shared services for connecting applications to *blockchain* networks.

Support RPC communication, *blockchain* event processing, transaction monitoring, confirmation tracking, and in*dex*ing while keeping *blockchain*-specific complexity isolated from product applications.

4. Internal Developer Platform

Create deployment pipelines, service templates, and self-service infrastructure that allow engineering teams to build and release applications efficiently.

Reduce repetitive configuration work and improve consistency across development environments.

5. Distributed Systems Reliability

Improve platform resilience during database outages, network interruptions, message-processing failures, and sudden traffic increases.

Design recovery mechanisms that prevent duplicate financial transactions or inconsistent application states.

6. Platform Observability

Establish monitoring and tracing across APIs, microservices, *blockchain* integrations, and transaction-processing pipelines.

Enable engineers to understand where failures occur and investigate production incidents quickly.

7. Secure Cloud Infrastructure

Build infrastructure with s*tron*g access controls, secrets management, network isolation, and secure deployment processes.

Work with security engineers to protect systems handling sensitive financial information and digital assets.

8. Multi-Product Platform Architecture

Design infrastructure that can support different products, including real estate payments, gaming transactions, sports betting settlement, and *Web3* social finance.

Identify which components should be shared and which should remain specific to individual applications.

Why This Role Matters

As we establish our planned software development operations in Poland, platform engineering will be essential to building reliable fintech and *Web3* applications.

Our products will require secure backend infrastructure, scalable transaction processing, reliable cloud systems, and efficient development workflows.

The Principal Platform Engineer will help establish the technical foundation that enables multiple engineering teams to build applications without repeatedly solving the same infrastructure problems.

This position offers significant ownership of architecture, distributed systems, developer infrastructure, and production reliability.

You will work directly with engineering leadership and contribute to technical decisions that affect the performance, security, and scalability of our products.

We are looking for an engineer who combines **deep software engineering expertise, s*trong* distributed systems knowledge, practical cloud infrastructure experience, and hands-on technical leadership**.

Our goal is to build a reliable platform that supports secure financial transactions, *blockchain* integrations, and scalable applications across multiple products.